

AAPL - Investment Memo

Horizon: swing (1-4w) | Model confidence: 62/100 (self-assessed, not calibrated)

WATCH

Scenario returns (model estimates)

Bull +6% (35%) | Base +1% (40%) | Bear -4% (25%) => probability-weighted +1.5%

Why (thesis)

- + Bullish A-tier options flow (\$12.1M premium, 87 trade score, 93 overnight conviction, 4 sweeps into 20% OTM calls) c
- + RS line at 52W high (prox_52w 99.7%, rs_vs_spy +19.1) with TickerDesk swing grade A- and strong-up trend (RSI 71, ab
- + Risk-on regime with small-cap leadership provides macro tailwind, and the Sep iPhone event (45-50 days out) offers a

What kills it (risks)

- x Zero insider buying in 90 days vs. 31 sales / -\$199M over 12 months (insider_quality -75 'bearish distribution') - i
- x Consensus positioning (65.7% inst own, 7,630 holders, analyst targets averaging \$315 vs. current \$332 - Street is BE
- x Base is wide (base_tight 7.03 vs. textbook <2.0) and volume is sub-average (0.45x), which while consistent with quie

Decision matrix

- 35% Bull: July 30 EPS/rev beat with Services >+15% Y/Y and iPhone unit guide 230M+ (above Street 225M), plus Apple In
- 40% Base: Inline print (EPS/rev meet, Services +13%, iPhone flat Y/Y) with cautious commentary on AI monetization tim
- 25% Bear: Services decelerates to +11% (below Street +14%), iPhone units guide 220M (down Y/Y), or Apple Intelligence

Thesis improves if

- > Pre-earnings dip to \$328-330 (pivot retest on profit-taking) with options flow maintaining A-tier bullish (sweeps in
- > Any material insider open-market BUY (>\$1M) from Cook, Maestri, or Williams between now and July 30 - would fully re
- > July 30 print beats with a RAISE to Sept-Q iPhone unit guide above 235M (vs. Street 225M) and explicit Apple Intelli

Thesis breaks if

- < Any additional insider Form 4 SALES >\$10M between now and July 30 - would deepen the distribution pattern and sugges
- < TickerDesk options flow flips to distribution (sweeps into Aug/Sep puts, or call sellers overwhelming buyers) - that
- < Close below \$325 (20MA) on volume >1.5x average before July 30 - that's a technical breakdown that says the accumula

Variant perception

- Consensus: The market believes Apple is a safe mega-cap anchor with Jul 30 earnings as a non-event (modest beat priced
- Variant: Variant view: The options flow (A-tier, \$12.1M, 20% OTM calls, 93 conviction) suggests institutions are pos

Position plan (ATR-derived, not advice)

Entry zone 330.54-334.84 | Stop 319.81 | Target 354.15 | R:R 1.7 (ATR14 8.59; entry +/-0.25xATR, stop 1.5x, target 2.5x - adjust to your structur

AAPL

Apple Inc.

\$332.69

+1.58%

RS vs SPY: +19.1%

B STRONG SETUP

\$4886.5B Cap | 14662M Float

Consumer Electronics | Theme: AI Consumer Hardware | 52W Hi: 100% | Base Tight: 7.03 | Vol: 0.45x | RS/SPY: +19.1% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 14D

Setup Metrics	
Price	\$332.69
Day Change	+1.58%
Mkt Cap	\$4886.50B
Float	14662M sh
RS vs SPY	+19.1%
52W Hi Prox	100%
Base Tight	7.03
Vol vs Avg	0.45x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	YES
Fwd P/E	34.6x
Short %	1.0%
Days to Cover	2.1d
Inst. Own	65.7%

ANALYSIS

Catalyst / Today's Driver

The current move is driven by quiet accumulation into a wide, multi-week base with RS line confirmation, suggesting institutional positioning ahead of Q3 earnings on July 30. The forward catalyst path centers on the July 30 print (14 days out) where Services revenue acceleration and preliminary Apple Intelligence adoption metrics could re-rate the multiple, followed by the September iPhone refresh event (historically late first week of Sept) where AI-native iPhone 16 positioning and installed-base upgrade commentary will be critical.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Apple is the world's largest consumer electronics company by market cap, with a vertically integrated hardware-software ecosystem spanning iPhone (52% of revenue), Services (24%), Mac (11%), iPad (7%), and Wearables (6%). Competitive edge rests on switching costs from the iOS ecosystem, premium brand pricing power, and a installed base of 2.2B+ active devices that monetizes recurring Services revenue at ~70% gross margin.

FACTOR & THEME

Primary exposure is AI consumer adoption (Apple Intelligence rollout across iOS 18 in Sept/Oct '26 creates the first mass-market on-device AI use case, potentially driving a super-cycle upgrade from the 300M+ iPhones aged 3+ years) and Services monetization (high-margin recurring revenue now 24% of mix, growing mid-teens, provides multiple expansion fuel). Secondary tailwind from U.S. reshoring narrative (Foxconn Arizona fab ramping, India production scaling to 25% of iPhone units by FY27) and emerging-market share gains (China stabilizing after 18-month erosion).

BREAKOUT SIGNAL

Close above \$333.55 (52W high pivot) on volume >0.6x of 20d avg (currently 0.45x)

INSTITUTIONAL

Institutional ownership at 65.7% with 7,630 holders reflects consensus overweight but not crowding (mega-cap index weight is structural, not discretionary). Volume today at 0.45x average is NOTABLE - this is quiet accumulation, not euphoria. TickerDesk options flow is unambiguous: A-tier bullish with \$12.1M premium, 4 sweeps, 35 blocks at 13.3x open interest, with 20% OTM strikes and repeat flow flagged. Overnight conviction scored 93 with 90.6% OI confirmation on bullish calls. This is smart-money positioning ahead of the July 30 catalyst, not retail chasing. CRITICAL NEGATIVE: Zero insider buying in the last 90 days against 31 sales totaling \$199M over 12 months (insider_quality score -75, 'bearish distribution'). This is the strongest disconfirming signal - insiders are net sellers at all-time highs, which historically flags stretched near-term risk/reward even if the business trajectory remains sound.

EARNINGS

EARNINGS IN 14D

EARNINGS CONTEXT

Next earnings July 30, 2026 (14 days). Consensus expects modest Y/Y growth with Services as the bright spot. Apple has beaten EPS in 8 of the last 8 quarters, typically guiding conservatively then beating by 3-5%, which re-rates the stock 2-4% post-print on average. The setup into this print is textbook: stock within 1% of ATH, RS line at new high, options flow aggressively bullish with 20% OTM calls. The risk is that the bar has been walked higher - any iPhone unit guidance below Street's 225M (implying flat Y/Y) or Services deceleration below +14% will flush positioning. Beat-and-raise is priced; inline is a fade.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalidated on a close below \$325 (the 20-day MA and lower bound of the recent range), or on any Services revenue guide below +12% Y/Y at the July 30 print, which would break the narrative that AI monetization is accelerating. The insider selling pattern (-\$199M, zero buys, -75 quality score) is a structural red flag that de-risks the position to half-size or swing-only duration until insiders step back in.

AAPL - Analysis (continued)

ANALYSIS

This is an elite mega-cap with RS line at new high, prox_52w 99.7%, bullish A-tier options flow (\$12.1M, 87 score, 93 overnight conviction), and a live catalyst 14 days out. The base is wide (base_tight 7.03 vs. ideal <2.0) and volume is BELOW average (0.45x) - which in this context is actually GOOD (quiet institutional accumulation, not retail blow-off). However, THREE factors downgrade from A to B: (1) The insider activity is unambiguously negative - zero buys, 31 sales, -\$199M net, quality score -75. Insiders are distributing at ATHs. (2) Market cap \$4.9T makes this a portfolio anchor, not a high-beta inflection trade; asymmetry is capped. (3) The setup is consensus - everyone sees July 30, everyone owns it, incremental-buyer fuel is limited unless the print materially surprises. The strongest disconfirming evidence is insider distribution at the high. Conviction: Medium - the technical and flow setup is pristine, but insider selling and consensus positioning cap upside to single-digit percentage points unless the earnings catalyst delivers a material re-rating. Risk-on regime supports follow-through, but size this as a lower-beta core hold, not a momentum chase.

Signal: Close above \$333.55 (52W high pivot) on volume >0.6x of
Vol vs Avg: 0.45x



INSIDER TRANSACTIONS - LAST 12 MONTHS

Source: SEC EDGAR Form 4 | P=open buy, S=sale, M=opt exercise, A=grant, F=tax withhold

12-Month Summary

Open-market buys: 0 (\$0) | Sales: 31 (\$199.00M) | Net: -\$199.00M | Total transactions: 71

Date	Insider	Title	Action	Shares	Price	Value
2026-06-16	Borders Ben	Principal Accounting O	Sale	116	\$295.14	\$34K
2026-06-15	Newstead Jennifer	SVP, GC and Secretary	Opt Exer	30,104	\$0.00	\$0
2026-06-15	Newstead Jennifer	SVP, GC and Secretary	Tax W/H	16,238	\$296.42	\$4.81M
2026-06-15	Borders Ben	Principal Accounting O	Opt Exer	240	\$0.00	\$0
2026-06-15	Borders Ben	Principal Accounting O	Tax W/H	124	\$296.42	\$37K
2026-05-27	LEVINSON ARTHUR D	10% Owner	Sale	50,000	\$311.02	\$15.55M
2026-05-27	LEVINSON ARTHUR D	10% Owner	Gift	65,000	\$0.00	\$0
2026-05-08	Borders Ben	Principal Accounting O	Sale	1,274	\$290.00	\$369K
2026-05-06	LEVINSON ARTHUR D	10% Owner	Sale	149,527	\$284.57	\$42.55M
2026-05-06	LEVINSON ARTHUR D	10% Owner	Sale	100,473	\$285.04	\$28.64M
2026-05-06	LEVINSON ARTHUR D	10% Owner	Gift	5,000	\$0.00	\$0
2026-04-23	Parekh Kevan	Senior Vice President,	Sale	1,534	\$275.00	\$422K
2026-04-15	Borders Ben	Principal Accounting O	Opt Exer	1,717	\$0.00	\$0
2026-04-15	Borders Ben	Principal Accounting O	Tax W/H	892	\$266.43	\$238K
2026-04-15	Parekh Kevan	Senior Vice President,	Opt Exer	10,928	\$0.00	\$0
2026-04-15	Parekh Kevan	Senior Vice President,	Tax W/H	4,793	\$266.43	\$1.28M
2026-04-02	O'BRIEN DEIRDRE	Senior Vice President	Sale	20,338	\$255.12	\$5.19M
2026-04-02	O'BRIEN DEIRDRE	Senior Vice President	Sale	9,664	\$255.82	\$2.47M
2026-04-02	COOK TIMOTHY D	Chief Executive Office	Sale	5,087	\$251.25	\$1.28M
2026-04-02	COOK TIMOTHY D	Chief Executive Office	Sale	9,147	\$252.11	\$2.31M
2026-04-02	COOK TIMOTHY D	Chief Executive Office	Sale	1,878	\$253.13	\$475K
2026-04-02	COOK TIMOTHY D	Chief Executive Office	Sale	16,083	\$254.37	\$4.09M
2026-04-02	COOK TIMOTHY D	Chief Executive Office	Sale	28,188	\$255.17	\$7.19M
2026-04-02	COOK TIMOTHY D	Chief Executive Office	Sale	4,566	\$256.00	\$1.17M
2026-04-01	O'BRIEN DEIRDRE	Senior Vice President	Opt Exer	64,317	\$0.00	\$0
2026-04-01	O'BRIEN DEIRDRE	Senior Vice President	Tax W/H	34,315	\$255.63	\$8.77M
2026-04-01	Khan Sabih	COO	Opt Exer	64,317	\$0.00	\$0
2026-04-01	Khan Sabih	COO	Tax W/H	33,317	\$255.63	\$8.52M
2026-04-01	COOK TIMOTHY D	Chief Executive Office	Opt Exer	131,576	\$0.00	\$0
2026-04-01	COOK TIMOTHY D	Chief Executive Office	Tax W/H	66,627	\$255.63	\$17.03M
2026-03-15	Newstead Jennifer	SVP, GC and Secretary	Opt Exer	60,208	\$0.00	\$0
2026-03-15	Newstead Jennifer	SVP, GC and Secretary	Tax W/H	32,528	\$250.12	\$8.14M
2026-02-26	LEVINSON ARTHUR D	Director	Gift	1,113	\$0.00	\$0
2026-02-01	WAGNER SUSAN	Director	Opt Exer	1,255	\$0.00	\$0
2026-02-01	SUGAR RONALD D	Director	Opt Exer	1,255	\$0.00	\$0
2026-02-01	LOZANO MONICA C	Director	Opt Exer	1,255	\$0.00	\$0
2026-02-01	LEVINSON ARTHUR D	Director	Opt Exer	1,113	\$0.00	\$0
2026-02-01	JUNG ANDREA	Director	Opt Exer	1,255	\$0.00	\$0
2026-02-01	Gorsky Alex	Director	Opt Exer	1,255	\$0.00	\$0
2026-02-01	Austin Wanda M	Director	Opt Exer	1,255	\$0.00	\$0

... Showing 40 of 71 total transactions

INSTITUTIONAL OWNERSHIP & FILINGS

Source: yfinance (13F snapshot) + SEC EDGAR (13D/13G filings)

Insider % 1.63%	Institutional % 65.7%	Inst. Float % 66.8%	# Institutions 7,630
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SMART MONEY SIGNAL: GREY - Insufficient Smart Money Evidence

Top 10 Institutional Holders

Fund	% Out	Shares	Value	Reported	Type
Blackrock Inc.	7.79%	1144.7M	\$380.89B	2026-03-31	Passive
Vanguard Capital Management LLC	6.49%	953.8M	\$317.39B	2026-03-31	Passive
State Street Corporation	4.10%	602.3M	\$200.43B	2026-03-31	Passive
Geode Capital Management, LLC	2.51%	368.6M	\$122.66B	2026-03-31	Passive
Vanguard Portfolio Management LLC	2.26%	331.4M	\$110.28B	2026-03-31	Passive
FMR, LLC	2.09%	307.4M	\$102.30B	2026-03-31	Active
Morgan Stanley	1.66%	244.5M	\$81.35B	2026-03-31	Active
JPMORGAN CHASE & CO	1.58%	231.6M	\$77.07B	2026-03-31	Active
Berkshire Hathaway, Inc	1.55%	227.9M	\$75.84B	2026-03-31	Active
Price (T.Rowe) Associates Inc	1.36%	200.4M	\$66.69B	2026-03-31	Active

Recent 13D / 13G Filings (last 12 months)

13D = activist stake, board pressure, takeover | 13G = passive 5%+ holder, lower-conviction

No 13D or 13G filings against this company in the last 12 months.

Ownership Interpretation

Smart Money:	Top holders skew 5 passive / 5 active. No high-conviction smart-money names identified.
Concentration:	Top 10 hold 31% - moderate concentration, normal for SMID.
13D/13G:	No 5%+ stake filings in last 12 months. Either nobody's gone over the threshold or the company is too large for 5% to be common (>\$10B caps rarely see 13D/G activity).
Insider Tape:	31 insider sales in 12 months, no open-market purchases - neutral to bearish (but typical for unprofitable growth companies).

INSTITUTIONAL FOOTPRINT - PRICE / VOLUME INTELLIGENCE

What institutions are doing right now (the price/volume tape never lies)

B

Accumulation

Score: 60.8/100

36 up days | 24 down days | 4 flat (last 65)

SILENT BUILD PATTERN

NOT PRESENT

No silent-build pattern in last 20 days.

Monthly Accumulation/Distribution Flow

Trend over last 3 months: are institutions accumulating, distributing, or rotating?

Period	Up-Vol %	A/D Trend	Price Chg	Vol vs Avg	Signal
3 Months Ago	70.9%	Strong Accumulation	+13.8%	0.90x	BULLISH
2 Months Ago	51.8%	Mixed	-2.6%	0.93x	Neutral
Last Month	64.1%	Accumulation	+12.2%	1.17x	Bullish

Significant Volume Days (Last 90 Days, >2x Average Volume)

Each row = a day institutions left a clear footprint. Absorption = stealth accumulation (silent buy).

Date	Close	Day Chg %	Volume	Rel Vol	Classification	Signal
2026-06-26	\$283.78	+3.1%	261,775,500	3.9x	ACCUMULATION	Bullish
2026-04-30	\$271.10	+0.4%	91,848,200	2.1x	ABSORPTION	Stealth Buy

Volume / Tape Synthesis

- A/D Verdict:

B-rated tape (Accumulation). Volume action favors buyers - institutions are net accumulating over the last 13 weeks.
- Trajectory:

Recent month is accumulation - building on prior momentum. Trend is on your side.
- Vol Footprint:

Last 90d: 1 accumulation, 1 absorption day(s) at >2x average volume. Net bullish - accumulation outpacing distribution.

TAPE-BASED ACTION: ACCUMULATE / SIZE UP ON BREAKOUT